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Coloniality, Civilisation and Constitution



Blowing mutinous sepoys from the guns, 8 September 1857

This is a hand-coloured steel engraving, detailing one of the activities post the suppression of the Uprising of 1857. London Printing and Publishing Company, 1858.

The discussions undertaken hitherto in the previous two sections on coloniality and civilisation are meant to serve as twin lenses to understand the influence of European coloniality/colonial consciousness on Bharat's journey as an indigenous civilisation towards constitutionalism. This section is, in fact, the intended culmination of the previous sections, and the specific object of my examination. One of the reasons for using coloniality as the broader canvas within which this journey is sought to be placed is to drive home the point that to limit the study of the history of Bharat's Constitution to the Constituent Assembly and its cogitations would be a truncated analysis. This is because it is important to examine the OET-framework within which the Assembly operated, consciously or